CHAPTER 11

The Future of Elixir

This book is coming to an end, but your Elixir journey is just starting. There's so much more to see and learn about Elixir! In the past few years, major advancements have come to the Elixir ecosystem that push many exciting new use cases for Elixir. In addition to these exciting advancements, there are useful topics for you to dive into after you finish this book.

It's important to see forward progress in languages that you use—otherwise, things feel stale. If you look at Ruby, a lot of exciting advances have been made in the past few years, such as new real-time capabilities, improvements to developer experience, consolidation of libraries into Rails core, and increased performance. Luckily, Elixir has also been developing at an amazing speed.

We'll look at the projects that are making up the future of Elixir: LiveView, machine learning with Nx, and development toward a type system. But before we cover those, there are a few key topics that are good to know about. We'll briefly cover deployment, observability, real-time apps, and GraphQL.

This chapter provides an intro to each topic—it's a jumping off point for areas that you're interested in. Be sure to make a mental note of the topics you want to explore in more detail later.

Let's kick it off by looking at deployment and observability.

Deployment and Observability

Building the first version of an app is just step one in getting users to use it. You need to deploy it to production, know that it's working properly, market it, support users, and so much more. This book won't help you with marketing or supporting an app, but it will help with deployment and observability!